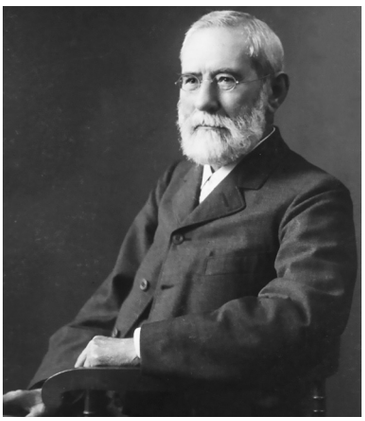


Schmiedeberg obtained his medical doctorate in 1866 with a thesis on the measurement of chloroform in blood. In 1872, he became professor of pharmacology at the University of Strassburg, receiving generous government support in the form of a magnificent institute of pharmacology. He studied the pharmacology of chloroform and chloralhydrate. In 1869, Schmiedeberg showed that muscarine evoked the same effect on the heart as electrical stimulation of the vagus nerve. In 1878, he published a classic text, ***Outline of Pharmacology*, and in 1885, he introduced urethane as a hypnotic.**

11.2 Definition:

The term pharmacology is obtained from the Greek word **"pharmakon"** meaning as drug and "logos" means the study or science. The term "drug" is derived from the French word "drogue" denotes" dry herb".

PHARMACOLOGY:- is the study of drugs. Drugs are the chemical substance that produce therapeutically useful effects.

Pharmacist: A person licensed to prepare and dispense drugs

Pharmacokinetics: It is the study of how medications enter the body, reach their site of action, are metabolized and exit the body

Pharmacodynamics: It is the study of drugs – their mechanism of action, pharmacological action and their side effects which deals with "what the drug does to the body"

11.3 Sources Of Drugs:

There are three varieties of sources – natural, semisynthetic and synthetic. Natural sources are plants, animals, microorganism, minerals, etc. semisynthetic drugs are obtained from natural sources and modified chemically later. Synthetic drugs are produced artificially.

The different sources of drugs are as follows:

Plants – morphine, atropine, digoxin

Animals – insulin

Minerals – ferrous sulphate, magnesium sulphate

Microorganisms – penicillin, streptomycin

Semisynthetic – hydromorphone

Synthetic – most of the drugs used today are synthetic – aspirin, paracetamol

Drugs are also produced by genetic engineering – human insulin, human growth hormone

11.4 Forms of Medication:

Medications are available in a variety of forms or preparations. The form of medication determines the route of administration.

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